IBM FileNet P8 V5.6.x

Hands-On Lab Exercise

Creating a FileNet P8 Domain

Using the Administration Console for Content Engine (ACCE)

Exercise	Estimated Time
LAB-01	**30 Minutes**
Course Day	**Difficulty**
Day 2 - Architecture	**Beginner (Level 2/5)**

Exercise Overview

Attribute	Details
Objective	Create a FileNet P8 Domain using ACCE and verify its successful creation in the GCD.
Prerequisites	IBM DB2 11.5 running. GCDDB created. Content Engine 5.2.1 deployed on WAS. JAVA_HOME set.
Tools Used	ACCE (Administration Console for Content Engine) at http://localhost:9080/acce
Outcome	A fully configured P8Domain registered in the GCD, ready for Object Store creation in Lab 02.
Related Course	Day 2: FileNet Architecture Deep Dive - GCD and Domain Configuration

Concept: What is a FileNet Domain?

A FileNet P8 Domain is the top-level administrative container in a FileNet environment. It is the first object created during deployment and serves several critical purposes:

- Groups all FileNet components (Object Stores, Content Engines, Process Engines) under a single namespace
- Is persisted in the Global Configuration Database (GCD) which you configured during installation
- Can contain only ONE domain per GCD database - choose the domain name carefully as it cannot be changed
- Stores system-wide security policies and configuration that apply to all Object Stores beneath it

> **KEY CONCEPT:** The Domain -> Object Store -> Document hierarchy is fundamental to FileNet. You cannot create an Object Store without a domain, and you cannot store documents without an Object Store.

Lab Environment Details

Field	Value to Enter	Notes
ACCE URL	**http://localhost:9080/acce**	*Open in Chrome or Firefox*
Admin Username	**ceadmin**	*Content Engine admin account*
Admin Password	**<as set during CE installation>**	*Refer to your lab credential sheet*
GCD Database	**GCDDB on localhost:50000**	*Must be running before starting*
Domain Name	**P8Domain**	*Use exactly this name for lab consistency*
Display Name	**FileNet Training Domain**	*Descriptive label shown in ACCE*
GCD JNDI Name	**jdbc/GCDDS**	*Configured in WAS during CE install*

BEFORE YOU START: Open a Command Prompt and verify DB2 is running. Run: db2 list active databases. GCDDB should appear. If not, start DB2 with: net start DB2-0

STEP 1 Launch ACCE and Log In

Open a browser and connect to the Content Engine admin console

1. Open Google Chrome or Mozilla Firefox on the lab machine.
2. Navigate to the ACCE URL:

```
http://localhost:9080/acce
```

3. On the login screen, enter the following credentials:

Field	Value to Enter	Notes
Username	**ceadmin**	
Password	**<your ceadmin password>**	*Set during CE installation*

4. Click Log In.
5. If prompted about an untrusted certificate (HTTPS), click Advanced then Proceed.

[Screenshot Placeholder]

Figure: *ACCE Login Screen - Enter ceadmin credentials and click Log In*

What You Should See After Login

After a successful login, the ACCE home page loads with:

- A left-hand navigation panel showing the Domain tree
- The main workspace area on the right
- A top menu bar with Domain, Object Stores, and Administration options

> **TROUBLESHOOTING:** If ACCE does not load, check that WAS is running. Open Services (services.msc) and confirm IBM WebSphere Application Server is started. Also verify http://localhost:9080 is reachable in the browser.

	Verification Check	Expected Result
[ ]	ACCE URL loads without a 404 or connection refused error	*ACCE login page displayed*
[ ]	Login with ceadmin credentials succeeds	*ACCE home/dashboard loads*
[ ]	Left navigation panel is visible	*Domain tree panel shown on left*

STEP 2 Open the New Domain Wizard

Navigate to the Domain creation entry point in ACCE

On a fresh Content Engine installation, ACCE may automatically prompt you to configure the domain. If not, follow the steps below:

6. In the ACCE left navigation panel, look for the Domain section.
7. If no domain exists yet, you will see a message in the workspace:

> No domain is configured. Click here to configure a domain.

8. Click that link, OR use the top menu bar: click Domain then select New Domain.
9. The New Domain wizard opens in the main workspace area on the right.

[Screenshot Placeholder]

Figure: *ACCE - New Domain wizard first screen (General Properties tab)*

> **IMPORTANT NOTE:** If a domain already exists in this environment (from a previous session), DO NOT create a second domain. A GCD database can hold only one domain. If a domain exists, skip ahead to Step 7 to verify its properties instead.

	Verification Check	Expected Result
[ ]	New Domain wizard is open in the ACCE workspace	*Multi-tab wizard form is visible*

STEP 3 Enter Domain General Properties

Fill in the domain name, display name, and description

The wizard opens on the General Properties tab. Fill in all fields exactly as shown in the table below:

Field	Value to Enter	Notes
Domain Name	**P8Domain**	*Permanent - cannot be changed after creation*
Display Name	**FileNet Training Domain**	*Human-readable label shown in ACCE*
Description	**IBM FileNet P8 Training Lab Environment**	*Optional but strongly recommended*
Comment	**Created during LAB-01**	*Optional audit trail note*

[Screenshot Placeholder]

Figure: *New Domain Wizard - General Properties tab with all fields filled in correctly*

> **CRITICAL:** The Domain Name field is permanent. Once created, the domain name cannot be renamed or changed. Always use 'P8Domain' exactly as written here - later lab exercises and configurations reference this exact name when connecting to the Content Engine.

10. After entering all fields, click Next to move to the GCD Configuration tab.

	Verification Check	Expected Result
[ ]	Domain Name field contains: P8Domain	*Exactly 'P8Domain' - no spaces, no typos*
[ ]	Display Name filled in	*FileNet Training Domain*
[ ]	No validation errors shown on the form	*All fields highlighted normally*

STEP 4 Configure the GCD Data Source

Connect the domain to the Global Configuration Database in DB2

The GCD Configuration tab links the new domain to the DB2 GCDDB database. This step is the most critical in the wizard - an incorrect data source connection will prevent domain creation.

Option A - Use Existing JNDI Data Source (Recommended)

Use this option if the CE installer pre-configured the JNDI data source in WebSphere Application Server:

11. On the GCD Configuration tab, select: Use existing data source.
12. In the JNDI Name field, enter:

```
jdbc/GCDDS
```

13. Click Test Connection to verify the DB2 connectivity.
14. Confirm the result shows: Connection test succeeded.

[Screenshot Placeholder]

Figure: *GCD Configuration tab - JNDI data source field with Test Connection button and success message*

Option B - Create New Data Source

Use this option only if no JNDI data source was pre-configured in WAS. Fill in all fields:

Field	Value to Enter	Notes
Data Source Name	**GCD Data Source**	*Any descriptive name*
JNDI Name	**jdbc/GCDDS**	*Must match what CE uses internally*
Server Name	**localhost**	*Or the DB2 server hostname / IP address*
Port Number	**50000**	*DB2 default listener port*
Database Name	**GCDDB**	*The GCD database you created during installation*
Username	**ceadmin**	*DB2 user with DBADM privilege on GCDDB*
Password	**<ceadmin DB2 password>**	

15. Click Test Connection - it must succeed before you can proceed to the next tab.

> **TROUBLESHOOTING:** If the connection test fails: (1) Confirm DB2 is running - run 'net start DB2-0' in a Command Prompt. (2) Confirm GCDDB exists - run 'db2 list db directory'. (3) Test manually: 'db2 connect to GCDDB user ceadmin using <pwd>'.

16. Once the connection test succeeds, click Next to proceed to the Administrator tab.

	Verification Check	Expected Result
[ ]	JNDI name jdbc/GCDDS is entered or created	*JNDI field populated*
[ ]	Connection test to GCDDB succeeds	*Message: Connection test succeeded*
[ ]	No error messages displayed on the GCD tab	*Tab shows no red/error indicators*

STEP 5 Set the Domain Administrator Account

Assign the CE administrator identity to the new domain

The Administrator tab defines which user account acts as the Content Engine domain administrator. This account receives Full Control over the entire domain and all objects beneath it.

17. On the Administrator tab, in the User Name field, enter:

```
ceadmin
```

18. Leave the Realm / Directory Server field set to the default (local OS realm). Do not modify this unless you are setting up LDAP authentication.
19. Confirm the following option is selected:

- Grant this user full administrative access to the domain

Field	Value to Enter	Notes
User Name	**ceadmin**	*Must be a valid OS or LDAP user account*
Realm	**(default)**	*Leave blank for local OS authentication*
Admin Rights	**Full Control**	*Ensure the grant full access checkbox is ticked*

[Screenshot Placeholder]

Figure: *Administrator tab - ceadmin entered as domain administrator with Full Control selected*

> **NOTE:** In a production environment, you would use a dedicated LDAP service account here rather than a local OS user. For this training lab, the local ceadmin OS account is sufficient and appropriate.

20. Click Next to proceed to the Summary tab.

	Verification Check	Expected Result
[ ]	ceadmin is set as the domain administrator	*Username field shows ceadmin*
[ ]	Full administrative access checkbox is selected	*Checkbox is ticked/checked*

STEP 6 Review Summary and Create the Domain

Verify all settings and trigger domain creation in the GCD

The Summary tab shows a complete review of every setting entered in the wizard. This is your last opportunity to go back and correct any mistakes before the domain is written to the GCD database.

Confirm All Values Match the Table Below

Field	Value to Enter	Notes
Domain Name	**P8Domain**	*Permanent identifier - verify carefully*
Display Name	**FileNet Training Domain**	
GCD JNDI Name	**jdbc/GCDDS**	
DB2 Database	**GCDDB on localhost**	*Port 50000*
Administrator	**ceadmin**	

[Screenshot Placeholder]

Figure: *Summary tab - final review showing all domain configuration values before creation*

21. Read through all summary values carefully.
22. If anything is incorrect, click Back to return to the relevant tab and correct it.
23. When all values are confirmed correct, click Finish (or Create Domain).

What Happens After You Click Finish

ACCE performs these operations automatically - this takes approximately 1 to 3 minutes:

- Connects to DB2 and initializes all GCD schema tables in GCDDB
- Creates the domain root object and registers it in the GCD
- Assigns the domain administrator permissions for ceadmin
- Registers the Content Engine server with the new domain

> **DO NOT CLOSE:** Do not close the browser or navigate away during domain creation. Wait for the progress indicator to complete fully and the success message to appear before doing anything else.

[Screenshot Placeholder]

Figure: *Domain creation in progress - progress indicator shown in ACCE workspace*

	Verification Check	Expected Result
[ ]	All summary values match the expected lab values in the table above	*No discrepancies found*
[ ]	Clicked Finish / Create Domain button	*Progress indicator appears*
[ ]	Domain creation completes without errors	*Success confirmation message shown*

STEP 7 Verify Domain Creation in ACCE

Confirm the domain appears in navigation and review its properties

After the success message appears, perform these verification checks to confirm the domain was created correctly and is fully functional.

7a - Check the Navigation Tree

24. Look at the left-hand navigation panel in ACCE after the success message appears.
25. You should see the domain name P8Domain listed as the root node in the tree.
26. Click on P8Domain to expand it. You will see the following sub-nodes:

- Object Stores - currently empty (you will create TrainingOS in Lab 02)
- Process Engine - not yet connected (you will configure this in Lab 06)
- Administration - contains security, audit, and server settings

[Screenshot Placeholder]

Figure: *ACCE left navigation panel - P8Domain expanded showing Object Stores, Process Engine, and Administration nodes*

7b - View Domain Properties

27. Click P8Domain in the left navigation tree.
28. In the main workspace on the right, click the Properties tab.
29. Verify the following property values are all correct:

Field	Value to Enter	Notes
Domain Name	**P8Domain**	*Must match exactly what you entered*
Display Name	**FileNet Training Domain**	
GCD Database	**GCDDB**	*The linked DB2 database*
Administrator	**ceadmin**	
Creation Date	**<today's date>**	*Confirms it was just created*
CE Server	**localhost**	*Content Engine hostname/IP*

[Screenshot Placeholder]

Figure: *Domain Properties tab in ACCE showing P8Domain details - verify all values match*

7c - Verify via DB2 Command Line

Optionally confirm the GCD schema was bootstrapped correctly in DB2:

30. Open a Command Prompt and connect to GCDDB:

```
db2 connect to GCDDB user ceadmin using <password>
```

31. List the tables in the GCD schema:

```
db2 list tables for schema GCD
```

Expected: A list of system tables appears including GCD.DOMAIN, GCD.OBJECTSTORE, GCD.SERVER, and others. The presence of these tables confirms the GCD schema was bootstrapped successfully by the domain creation wizard.

	Verification Check	Expected Result
[ ]	P8Domain appears as root node in ACCE left navigation tree	*Root node labeled P8Domain*
[ ]	Domain Properties - Domain Name shows: P8Domain	*Exact match, case-sensitive*
[ ]	Domain Properties - Display Name correct	*FileNet Training Domain*
[ ]	Domain Properties - Administrator shows ceadmin	*Exact match*
[ ]	DB2: GCD schema tables exist in GCDDB	*GCD.DOMAIN and related tables listed*

STEP 8 Explore Domain Administration Settings

Familiarise yourself with key domain management options in ACCE

Now that the domain is created, take a few minutes to explore the administration areas below. You will use these settings in later lab exercises throughout the course.

8a - Domain Security

32. In the ACCE left panel, click P8Domain then expand Administration, then click Security.
33. Observe the Access Control List (ACL). The ceadmin account should be listed with Full Control access.
34. Note the security inheritance setting. By default, Object Stores created beneath this domain will inherit domain-level security entries.

8b - Domain Audit Settings

35. Navigate to P8Domain then Administration then Audit.
36. Observe that auditing is disabled by default in a fresh installation.
37. Make a note: In production deployments, audit logging would be enabled here to meet compliance and governance requirements (covered in Day 5).

8c - Content Engine Server Registration

38. Navigate to P8Domain then Administration then Servers.
39. You should see the Content Engine server (localhost) registered under the domain.
40. Click the server entry to view its properties. Note the CE version (5.2.1) and its current status.

[Screenshot Placeholder]

Figure: *ACCE Administration panel showing Security ACL, Audit settings, and registered CE Server under P8Domain*

> **EXPLORE:** These domain administration settings map directly to Day 5 course content on Storage and Security Administration. Keep notes on what you observe here as you will revisit and configure these settings in Lab 05.

	Verification Check	Expected Result
[ ]	Domain Security ACL shows ceadmin with Full Control	*ACL entry visible with Full Control*
[ ]	Content Engine server (localhost) is registered under the domain	*Server entry shows status Active*

Exercise Summary

LAB-01 COMPLETE

You have successfully created a FileNet P8 Domain using ACCE. The domain P8Domain is now registered in the GCD (GCDDB) and the Content Engine is configured to serve as its host.

What You Accomplished

- Logged into ACCE and navigated the domain administration interface
- Configured the GCD data source connection to DB2 GCDDB database
- Created the domain P8Domain with ceadmin as domain administrator
- Verified domain creation in both ACCE (properties tab) and DB2 (schema tables)
- Explored domain security, audit settings, and CE server registration

Key Concepts Reinforced

Concept	What You Observed
GCD (Global Config DB)	GCDDB stores all domain and Object Store metadata. It is the single source of truth for the entire FileNet installation.
Domain as Root Container	P8Domain is the top-level namespace. Everything (Object Stores, PE connections, security) lives beneath it.
One Domain per GCD	ACCE allows only one domain per GCD database. This is why the domain name is permanent and cannot be changed.
JNDI Data Source	WAS manages the JDBC connection pool (jdbc/GCDDS) so FileNet components never hard-code database credentials.
Domain Administrator	ceadmin now has inherited Full Control over every Object Store and every document created in this domain.

Next Lab

> **NEXT - LAB-02:** Create an Object Store. You will create the TrainingOS Object Store beneath P8Domain, configure its DB2 data source using OSDB, and set up the physical content storage area on disk. Object Stores are covered in Day 3: Content Engine Fundamentals.

Troubleshooting Reference

Problem	Resolution
ACCE page does not load (404 or connection refused)	Start WAS via services.msc. Locate IBM WebSphere Application Server, click Start. Wait 60 seconds then retry the URL.

Login fails with Invalid credentials error	Confirm ceadmin OS account exists with the correct password. Reset via Computer Management then Local Users and Groups.
GCD connection test fails	1) Start DB2: net start DB2-0. 2) Confirm GCDDB exists: db2 list db directory. 3) Check ceadmin has DBADM on GCDDB.
Domain already exists error	A domain is already registered in GCDDB. Navigate to the existing domain in ACCE and verify its properties instead of creating a new one.
Domain creation hangs or freezes	Check the WAS log at: C:\IBM\WebSphere\AppServer\profiles\FileNetServer\logs\server1\SystemOut.log for error details.
DB2 schema tables not visible	Reconnect to GCDDB: run db2 terminate then db2 connect to GCDDB. GCD schema tables appear under schema name GCD.